



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES
May 19, 2026

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by Vice Mayor Freddie Dancy.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn.

ROLL CALL:

First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Shalanda Hunt, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: Mayor Daniel Mahoney

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, Deputy Clerk Cynthia Clementin, Fire Chief Tim Gonzales, Police Chief Chris Simpson, Director of Community Development Shane LaPorte, Director of Public Works Mike Osborn, and City Engineer Troy White.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to adopt the agenda. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS: none.

PUBLIC HEARINGS: none.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

- A. Minutes of the Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council on 21 April 2026.**
Approve the proposed minutes from the regular meeting of the Jackson City Council on 21 April 2026.
- B. Minutes of the Budget Workshop on 5 May 2026.**
- C. Reappointment to the Administrative Hearings Bureau**
Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Fred Bishop as an Administrative Hearings Bureau Officer for the City of Jackson's Administrative Hearings Bureau for a two-year term, beginning June 14, 2026, and ending June 13, 2028.
- D. Reappointment to the Environmental Commission**
Approve the Mayor's recommendation to reappoint Kelli Kazmier to fill a vacancy on the Planning Commission for a 3-year term, beginning May 30, 2026, and ending on May 29, 2029.
- E. Appointment to the Planning Commission**
Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Kelli Kazmier to fill a vacancy on Planning Commission for a three-year term, beginning immediately and expiring on December 31, 2029.
- F. Resignations from the Downtown Development Authority**
Accept with regret, the resignations of Laura Janiak and Roberta Dalenberg from the Downtown Development Authority, effective immediately.
- G. City of Jackson, Michigan Financial Statements for the Nine Months Ended March 31, 2026.**
- H. Special Event Application: Cruise-In & Concerts 2026**
Approve a request from the Jackson Downtown Development Authority to host the 2026 Cruise-In & Concerts on 5/22/26, 6/26/26, 7/24/26, 8/28/26, and 9/25/26, in downtown Jackson.

I. Special Event Application: Sheriff Open House

Approve a request from the Jackson County Office of the Sheriff to host the Sheriff Open House on June 7, 2026, in downtown Jackson.

J. Special Event Application: St. John's Day Parade

Approve a request from the St. Nicholas Lodge #12 to host the St. John's Day Parade on June 28, 2026, in downtown Jackson.

K. Special Event Application: Family Fun Festival

Approve a request from the Home of New Vision to host the Family Fun Festival on July 25, 2026, in downtown Jackson.

L. Special Event Application: Overdose Awareness Day Event

Approve a request from the Home of New Vision to host the Overdose Awareness Day Event on August 31, 2026, in downtown Jackson.

M. Special Event Application: Paws in the Park

Approve a request from the Cascades Human Society to host Paws in the Park on May 30, 2026, in downtown Jackson.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the consent calendar. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS:

A. East Side Economic Development Update

City Manager Jonathan Greene will schedule a meeting in early June. Specific date, time and place will be announced soon.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. Resolution - Charter Amendment making the Office of the City Treasurer a City Council-appointed position

Recommendation: *Adopt a resolution approving a proposed Charter Amendment making the Office of the City Treasurer a City Council-appointed position, as opposed to elected, and direct the City Attorney to submit the resolution and proposed ballot language to the Office of Attorney General and Governor of the State of Michigan for approval for the November 3, 2026 General Election.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to adopt a resolution approving a proposed charter amendment making the Office of City Treasurer a City Council-appointed position, as opposed to elected, and direct the City Attorney to submit the resolution and proposed ballot language to the Office of Attorney General and Governor of the State of Michigan for approval for the November 3, 2026 General Election. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Forgrave (5). Nays: Councilmember Hunt (1). Motion carried.

B. Resolution – Annual Budget for Fiscal Year 2026/2027

Recommendation: *Adoption of the Annual Budget Resolution for Fiscal Year 2026/2027 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to sign the 2026 Tax Rate Request (form L-4029).*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to adopt the Annual Budget Resolution for the Fiscal Year 2026/2027 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to sign the 2026 Tax Rate Request (form L-4029). Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried

C. Resolution(s) – Consumers Energy Standard Lighting Contract changes

Recommendation: *Approve the two resolutions for changes to the Standard Lighting Contract with Consumers Energy for the replacement of streetlights at 300 E. Addison and 738 E. Mansion and authorize the City Engineer and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Robinson, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the two resolutions for changes to the Standard Lighting Contract with Consumers Energy for the replacement of streetlights at 300 E. Addison and 738 E. Mansion and authorize the City Engineer and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried

D. Resolution – Modification of the FY29 Transportation Improvement Plan (TIP)

Recommendation: *Adopt a resolution of support for the modification of the FY29 Transportation Improvement Plan (TIP) and accept the requirement that the City pay the local match for the selected projects.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to adopt a resolution of support for the modification of the FY29 Transportation Improvement Plan (TIP) and accept the requirement that the City pay the local match for the selected projects. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. Resolution – USDOT and MDOT Agreement

Recommendation: *Approve a resolution to enter into an agreement with the United States Department of Transportation (USDOT) and the Michigan Department of Transportation (MDOT) for street reconstruction on the East Side Commerce Corridor from Cooper Street to the east City Limits and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve a resolution to enter into an agreement with the United States Department of Transportation and the Michigan Department of Transportation for street reconstruction on the East Side Commerce Corridor from Cooper Street to the east City Limits and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

F. Resolution – City’s Right of First Refusal

Recommendation: *Approve a Resolution to Exercise the City’s Right of First Refusal for 3 Parcels and Decline 50 Parcels under PA 123 of 1999*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve a resolution to exercise the City’s Right of First Refusal for three parcels and decline fifty parcels under PA 123 of 1999. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

G. Ordinance – First Reading of the Nonunion Wage Table Effective 7/1/2026

Recommendation: *Approve the first reading and advance to the second reading/final adoption, an ordinance regulating nonunion pay for City of Jackson Employees to increase wages 3.0% effective July 1, 2026.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the first reading and advance to the second reading/final adoption, an ordinance regulating nonunion pay for City of Jackson employees to increase wages 3.0% effective July 1, 2026. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

H. Wastewater Service Agreement – Blackman, Rives, Spring Arbor, Napoleon, and Summit Townships and the Southern Michigan State Prison.

Recommendation: *Approve a Wastewater Treatment Service Agreement between the City of Jackson and the Townships of Blackman, Rives, Spring Arbor, Napoleon and Summit as well as the Southern Michigan State Prison according to the terms as negotiated and Appoint Councilperson Arlene Robinson and DPW Director Michael Osborn to the Sewer Advisory Board.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve a Wastewater Treatment Service Agreement between the City of Jackson and the Townships of Blackman, Rives, Spring Arbor, Napoleon and Summit as well as the Southern Michigan State Prison according to the terms as negotiated and appoint Councilperson Arlene Robinson and DPW Director Michael Osborn to the Sewer Advisory Board. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

I. Contract – Wastewater Digester Improvement Project Construction

Recommendation: *Approve the Wastewater Digester Improvement Project Construction Contracts as presented in the amount of \$7,203,735.00 and amend the previously approved Construction Management Agreement with Fishbeck to include their general conditions costs of \$997,500.00 and a 4% construction management cost of \$328,050.00 for a total project cost of \$9,590,952.00.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the Wastewater Digester Improvement Project Construction Contracts as presented in the amount of \$7,203,735.00 and amend the previously approved Construction Management Agreement with Fishbeck to include their general conditions costs of \$997,500.00 and a 4% construction management cost of \$328,050.00 for a total project cost of \$9,590,952.00. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

J. Change Order No. 3 – Monroe Plumbing & Heating Co. Contract

Recommendation: *Approval of Final Change Order No. 3, to the Monroe Plumbing & Heating Co., contract for the DWSRF FY 2023 Improvements.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Hunt for Approval of Final Change Order No. 3, to the Monroe Plumbing & Heating Co., contract for the DWSRF FY 2023 Improvements. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion Carried.

K. Change Order No. 1 – Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Lining Contract

Recommendation: *Approve Change Order 1 to the Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Lining contract with Inland Water Pollution Control, Inc. in the increased amount of \$55,437.40 to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document.*

Motion was by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Wood to Approve Change Order 1 to the Water Treatment Plant Sanitary Sewer Lining contract with Inland Water Pollution Control, Inc. in the increased amount of **\$55,737.40** to balance contract quantities to match quantities placed in the field and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to execute the appropriate document. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion carried.

L. Amendment 3 – Fiscal Year 2023 DWSRF Construction Services Professional Services Contract

Recommendation: *Approval of Amendment 3 to the Fiscal Year 2023 DWSRF Construction Administration Services Professional Services Contract with Fishbeck, Inc. of Grand Rapids, Michigan in the amount of \$540,000.00, and authorization for the City Manager, Director of Public Works, and City Engineer to sign the appropriate document.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Gunn, seconded by Councilmember Robinson for the approval of Amendment 3 to the Fiscal Year 2023 DWSRF Construction Administration Services Professional Services Contract with Fishbeck, Inc. of Grand Rapids, Michigan in the amount of \$540,000.00, and authorization for the City Manager, Director of Public Works, and City Engineer to sign the appropriate document. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion Carried.

M. Sale of City-Owned Property

Recommendation: *Approve the sale of City-owned property located at 515 N. Martin Luther King, Jr. Drive and 603 N. Martin Luther King Jr. Drive, Jackson, MI 49201 to W & W Property Management LLC for the total sum of \$600, approve the Purchase/Development Agreement, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction.*

Motion made by Councilmember Hunt, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the sale of City-owned property located at 515 N. Martin Luther King Drive and 603 N. Martin Luther King Jr. Drive, Jackson, MI 49201 to W & W Property Management LLC for the total sum of \$600, approve the Purchase/Development Agreement, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion Carried.

N. Lot Purchase Agreement – DJW Development LLC

Recommendation: *Approve the lot purchase agreement between the City of Jackson and DJW Development LLC, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the lot purchase agreement between the City of Jackson and DJW Development LLC, authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to make minor modifications as needed, and authorize the City Manager and City Attorney to execute the appropriate documents necessary to complete the transaction. Vote – Yeas: Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: none. Motion Carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER’S COMMENTS:

Vice Mayor Dancy, and Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave all offered comments.

MANAGER’S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene offered comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Councilmember Hunt, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave. Vice Mayor Dancy adjourned the meeting at 7:36 p.m.